

Microsoft Financial Performance Dashboard

Executive Summary — Excel Financial Analysis Project

Business Context

This dashboard analyzes the Microsoft Financial Sample dataset, covering sales performance across 5 countries, 6 products, 5 customer segments, and multiple discount bands. The analysis was built in Excel using Pivot Tables, PivotCharts, KPI cards, and interactive slicers. The objective is to identify revenue drivers, profitability gaps, and discount inefficiencies to inform strategic business decisions.

Key Findings

- **Paseo is the top-performing product** at \$32.4M in sales — nearly double the next closest product, making it the single largest revenue driver in the portfolio.
- **Revenue peaks sharply in October and November**, indicating a consistent seasonal demand pattern that should be anticipated in inventory and marketing planning.
- **Mexico generates the lowest sales of all 5 countries**, underperforming Canada and the United States by a significant margin despite operating in the same product catalog.
- **The High discount band accounts for the largest share of total discounts** at \$5.5M of \$9.2M total — heavy discounting is directly compressing the overall 14.23% profit margin.
- **The Government segment drives the majority of profit at \$11.4M**, while the Enterprise segment operates at a loss, representing an unsustainable sales pattern requiring immediate review.

Business Recommendations

- **Prioritize Paseo in inventory and marketing planning.** Analyze the drivers behind its performance and apply those strategies to underperforming products such as Carretera and Montana.
- **Increase inventory and marketing spend in Q3** to prepare for the October–November seasonal revenue surge and avoid stockouts during peak demand months.
- **Audit Mexico's pricing, distribution, and marketing strategy** and increase targeted regional investment to close the performance gap with Canada and the United States.
- **Cap or reduce High-band discounts to protect profit margin.** At 14.23%, overall margin is already thin — shifting promotions toward Medium-band discounts would meaningfully improve profitability.
- **Expand Government segment contracts and audit Enterprise pricing.** Selling at a loss in Enterprise is unsustainable; a pricing and cost structure review should be prioritized immediately.

